Improving ChatGPT Voice Tech Usage

This document shall outline solution to increase usage of ChatGPT's conversational feature

Problem Definition

- **ChatGPT's voice feature is significantly underutilized** despite strong technical capability and growing market readiness **simply due to Awareness & Discoverability issues**.
- This problem is **primarily faced by working professionals who either remain unaware of the feature or fail to discover and understand its use cases** within the product.
- **Solving this will unlock increased engagement, retention, and differentiation in the competitive voice AI space**, especially as competitors are already improving experiences.
- Users will **benefit through faster, hands-free, and more natural interactions** in relevant scenarios like multitasking, brainstorming, and communication.
- This **problem is urgent because there are clear drop-offs across the adoption funnel** and early signs of competitor preference and potential user migration.

Commented [AB1]: Google Gemini is the main competitor.

Goals

- Increase conversation feature adoption rate
- Improve first-time voice usage (trial rate)
- Improve repeat usage (retention of voice users)

Commented [AB2]: Tackling this first will not only cover targeted segment but also other segments with this same issue which is a business scale benefit.

- **Solution Prioritization (RICE Framework)**

Proposed Solutions	Reach	Impact	Confidence	Effort	Score
Introduce VT discovery & onboarding in existing ChatGPT UI/UX	3	2	2	1	(3x2x2)/1=**12**
Digital Marketing, TV ads for awareness	3	3	2	3	(2x3x2)/3=**6**
Full UI Revamp for better discoverability	3	3	3	3	(3x3x3)/3=**9**

- **Important Metrics**
  - Functional Metrics
    - **% of users who discover** voice feature
    - **% of users who initiate** first voice interaction
    - **Voice usage rate** (% of sessions using voice compared to overall)
    - **Repeat usage rate** (users using voice multiple times/week)
  - Non-Functional Metrics
    - Feature discoverability rate
    - Time to first voice interaction
    - Drop-off rate during onboarding
- **Why These Metrics Matter**
  - Discovery ensures awareness gap is solved
  - First usage validates reduced friction
  - Repeat usage proves real value creation
  - Engagement metrics tie directly to business impact (retention, **revenue**)

Commented [AB3]: When users realize it's real value and run into usage limits, it will push them to purchase Pro plans leading to increase in revenue eventually.

Non-Goals

- Integrations with Android and/or IOS phones for direct usage cases.
- Improving voice quality or conversational intelligence
- Adding new capabilities (file generation, coding, etc.)
- Solving social awkwardness or environmental constraints
- Large-scale UI redesign of entire ChatGPT interface
- External marketing campaigns (digital ads, TV, etc.)

Focus is strictly on DISCOVERABILITY + GUIDED ONBOARDING within the product.

Validation of the problem

- Insights from user research/data
  - ***Multiple users are unaware*** *of the feature.*
  - ***Multiple users are aware but have never used it.***
  - ***Multiple users have tried but rarely use it.***
- Key observations
  - *Users find it* ***difficult to discover the button****. Many have found it mostly via self-discovery.*
  - ***Lack of clear use case*** *and a default* ***preference to text****.*
  - *Awareness is clearly not translating to adoption.*
- Insights from competitive landscape, if any
  - ***Google Gemini preferred due to better integration with Android Phones.***

Understanding the target audience

- User segment in focus and the size of the segment
  - **Working Professionals (FTE) ~145M-160M potential users**; high value segment with clear productivity use case.
- Key personas and the user journeys involved
  - Busy Professional
  - Curious Explorer
  - Drop-Off User
- User Journey (Current)
  - Opens ChatGPT mobile app
  - Defaults to typing
  - **Either**: Never discovers voice OR Discovers it accidentally
  - Tries once (via hit & trial since onboarding missing)
  - Drops off
- Unmet needs (goals and pain points)
  - Clear awareness of feature existence & guidance on how to use it.
  - Understanding of when to use voice vs text.
  - Low-friction entry into voice experience.

Commented [AB4]: Siri or Google Assistant like functionality deferred at the moment.

Commented [AB5]: This is important but adoption and usage improvement needs to be focused more on before bringing niche aspects into perspective.

Commented [AB6]: Android phone adoption is already more than 80% in India which increases the competitor's advantage.

Commented [AB7]: Uses ChatGPT for work tasks Needs quick, efficient interaction

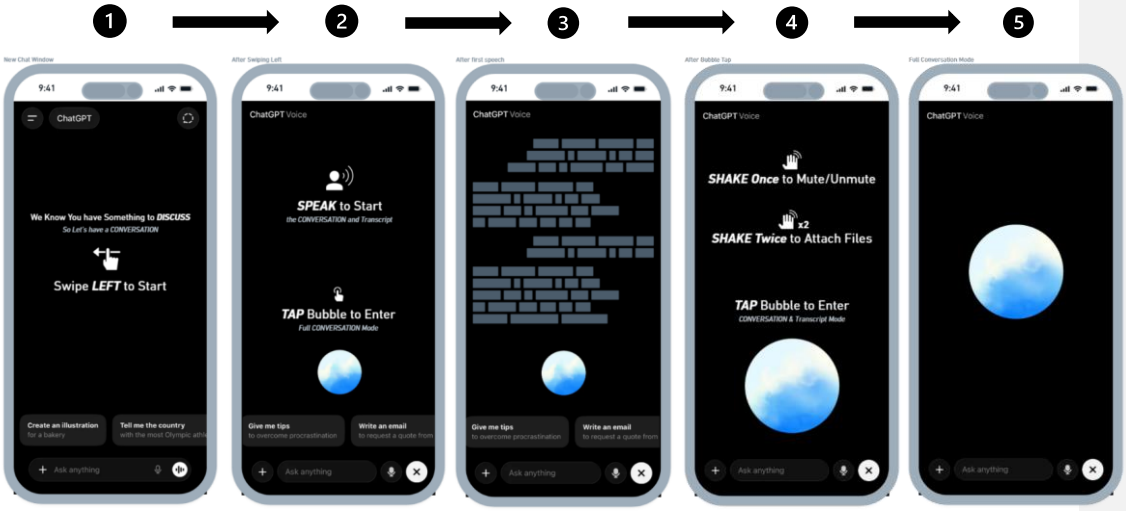
Commented [AB8]: Knows about features but doesn't actively use them

Commented [AB9]: Tried voice but didn't find value or clarity

Solution

Introducing a guided onboarding and **contextual education layer within the ChatGPT mobile app** interface to improve discoverability and drive adoption of the voice feature. This solution is derived from:

- ***User research*** *showing discoverability gaps.*
- ***Behavioural insights*** *showing lack of guided usage.*
- ***Competitive insights*** *highlighting better onboarding elsewhere.*



- User Flows (Based on Wireframes)
  - 1 Entry Screen (New Chat Introduces voice immediately)
    - On-Screen Prompt: "Swipe left to start conversation"
  - 2 After Swipe: Voice Onboarding Screen ***(Instructions fade after first speech)***
    - "Speak to start"
    - "Tap bubble for full conversation mode"
  - 3 First Interaction
    - Live transcription + response as user speaks, building confidence
  - 4 Feature Tips Layer ***(Instructions fade after first speech)***
    - Gesture-based education (shake, tap, etc.)
  - 5 Full Conversation Mode (Already Existing: No Change required)
    - Minimal UI focused on voice interaction only.
- Key Features & Logic:
  - **Always visible** voice entry option triggers onboarding for New users **OR** Users who haven't used voice.
  - First-time onboarding for voice feature & **guided interaction flow.**
  - 6 **In-App contextual nudges during extended usage.** Nudges pop up when Users type single long queries **OR** multiple back and forth prompts.
  - **Gesture-based shortcuts** (shake, tap) eliminating manual intervention.

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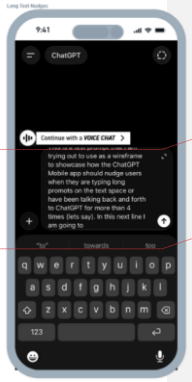

Commented [AB10]: New Chat window is the first screen any user lands on when opening ChatGPT Mobile app. Therefore, voice usage nudges should start from this screen itself.

Commented [AB11]: A known, common & easy accessibility action added for voice feature along with temporary and easily understandable On-Screen guide icons and texts. The guides can be turned off from settings once familiar with.

Commented [AB12]: Unless turned off from Settings.

Commented [AB13]: This ensures that the user is reminded from time to time about the value it can get with the conversation feature to put out long prompts and extended sessions compared to experience in text which requires a lot of effort to type and concentrate to type the right things.

Launch Readiness

- Key Milestones
  - Stakeholder Alignment & Design finalization
  - Engineering Development
  - QA Testing & Internal Dogfooding
  - **A/B experiment** rollout
  - Phased Rollout Planning
- Launch Checklist
  - Product & Design: Feature works across devices with Clear and non-intrusive UX
  - Engineering: Stable rollout and tracking
  - Analytics: Metrics tracking implemented
  - Support: Help docs / FAQs updated
- **Stakeholders**: *Product Manager, Designers, Engineers, Data/Analytics team, QA team*
- Experimentation plan:
  - **A/B Testing**:
    - Control Version - Existing experience
    - Test Version - New onboarding experience
  - Measure:
    - *Discovery rate*
    - *First usage*
    - *Retention*
  - Gradual rollout based on results

Open Questions & Decisions Taken

- Open Questions:
  - How frequently should onboarding be shown?
  - Should onboarding be skippable or mandatory?
  - What is the optimal level of nudging without being intrusive?
- Decisions Taken:
  - Focus on awareness & discoverability first, not feature or value expansion.
  - Use in-product education over external marketing.
  - Prioritized low-effort, high-impact solution using RICE Framework.
- Descoped:
  - Voice feature capability improvements & Full UI redesign
  - External digital & TV campaigning
- List of trade-offs made:

Trade Offs	Reason
Not focusing on UI Revamp	*Too much effort for this stage*
Not focusing on Features	*Does not solve root cause*
Limited Scope (Onboarding Only)	*For quick TAT to driving awareness*

Commented [AB14]: Launching for internal usage as an additional quality assurance and bug testing layer as well as closest match to target segment.

Commented [AB15]: This is because feature related feedback is very low. Target is to expand the usage first so that enough valuable insights can be gathered before moving towards feature expansion.

Commented [AB16]: The plan is to onboard and retain existing and potential users who are already aware and/or unaware rather than bring in new users. External marketing comes with additional budget demands as well which is to be deferred at the moment.

Commented [AB17]: Demands more TAT, resources and budget.